

What can teachers do to support students' studying?

The education system does all it can (and it does a lot) to maximise marks. Except, we tell students to study without apparently any concern for how they go about it. If students don't study well it is probably the biggest contributor to disappointing marks. This is the reason for *Study Smarter*.

Teachers *can* support studying as part of their everyday practice. The below practices require very little or only once-off effort, no special skills, and are easy to do. Adopting them is a matter of being intentional in the classroom; adopting them sets your students up for much improved marks and ultimately valence for school.

1=very UNTRUE of me >>> 5=very TRUE of me

1. TEXTBOOKS	1	2	3	4	5
a. I make it clear what in the textbook needs to be studied versus left out					
2. HANDOUTS					
a. When I make a handout I am mindful of how students will potentially study from it					
b. My handouts are clear, it's clear where each handout fits with others, and longer handouts have a clear document structure					
c. I give chapter outlines/skeletons at the start of a section for students to have a clear idea of the content structure					
3. SUPPORTED PLANNING					
a. I issue work plans at the start of the year/term with detail of content to be covered/omitted and when					
b. I issue 'what to expect in this subject' and 'how to do well in this subject' info at the start of each year.					
c. I set study planning as homework or do it as guided practice in class					
4. NOTEBOOKS					
a. I am mindful of how students will use their notebooks for studying					
b. I guide students to head work clearly and consistently					
c. I use the left hand page for handouts, and the adjacent right hand page for explanations, worked examples, etc					
d. I guide students not to make good use of space - no blank pages, no in-line doodles, and notes pasted in					
e. I guide students to make work to be studied easily distinguishable from other work					
f. I support the use of sections, such as section for definitions, rules or glossary					
g. I teach students how to get the most out of worked examples – head/number them clearly, and flag mistakes prominently in a consistent way for later revision					
h. I get students to maintain a record of their marks with a reflective comment for each result.					
5. CLASS TEACHING					
a. I make the purpose/aim of every lesson clear so students know what to focus on					
b. I try to start a lesson by showing how it links with 'yesterdays' lesson					

c. Modelling/making thinking visible is a prominent feature of my classes – talking through problem solving, how best to make study notes/memorise content according to its nature					
d. I make clear what is needed versus what is not (for enrichment/explanation)					
e. I give clues to work likely to be asked to how it is likely to be asked					
f. I regularly test 'yesterday's lesson'					
g. I regularly ask questions that require students to think back to their learning					
h. I try to create/engineer success in my students by being mindful of the tasks I set					
6. TESTS					
a. In tests, I don't ask marginal material or use formats students aren't used to					
b. I take time to teach students how to answer tests, i.e. I teach test taking skills AND I issue notes on it					
c. I try to get students to identify the root cause of issues, e.g. by encouraging 5 whys					
d. I have AT LEAST two past papers that students haven't seen uploaded PER test/exam WITH memos					
7. HOMEWORK					
a. I encourage daily READING over work i.e. practice retrieval at home					
b. I only issue meaningful homework					
c. When I give homework examples I am careful to balance block examples (for new work) vs interleaved example (for mastery)					
d. I set homework time aside for making study notes per section					
8. LEVERAGE SMART STUDYING PRINCIPLES: Familiar with terminology and use it appropriately					
a. The following words/terms are part of my regular vocab: taking control, mindset, reflection/metacognition, fulfilment, achievement and effort, ownership, transformation, 'tools'					
b. I have a good understanding of what makes well set goals and action plans. I get students to take them seriously					
c. I am familiar with the <i>Study Smarter</i> attributes of what we remember, and the 'universal' features of learning					
d. I leverage memory tools (11 of them in <i>Study Smarter</i>) and encourage transformation and deeper processing level					

Where could my support be better?

What things resonated with me as something to consider?

Are any activities unrealistic?

What practices am I going to adopt?